CLASS 8 — ENGLISH GULMOHAR · HARD LEVEL UNIT TEST SET 3

Chapters 5–8: **The Rock and the Sea, Patol Babu, Film Star, My Greatest Olympic Prize, Failure** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 2 Hours Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 50**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–15 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 16–20 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 21–25 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 26–27 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 24–25 and Q. 26–27.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 15 × 1 = 15

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. A fair criticism of the 'medals are nothing' view would be that: 1

(a) rivals never help **(b)** athletes work hard for medals too
(c) friendship is unimportant **(d)** medals are illegal

2. Why might the poet have chosen a rough black lump of coal rather than a rock? 1

(a) coal turns into a diamond in common imagery
(b) coal is bigger
(c) coal is cheaper
(d) coal is shiny

3. Which proverb is closest to the poem's moral? 1

(a) A stitch in time **(b)** Too many cooks spoil the broth
(c) Birds of a feather **(d)** Slow and steady wins the race

4. The word 'apathy' means: 1

(a) lack of interest **(b)** anger **(c)** haste **(d)** great joy

5. Reported speech: Long said, 'Make a mark.' 1

(a) Long asked what mark. **(b)** Long told make mark.
(c) Long told him to make a mark. **(d)** Long said make a mark.

6. Choose the correct passive: 'We must climb the hill.' 1

(a) The hill is climb. **(b)** We are climbed by the hill.
(c) The hill must be climbed. **(d)** The hill must climb.

7. The Sea says mountains 'crumble back' into it. This suggests: 1

(a) a cycle of rising and falling **(b)** that the Sea is dry
(c) that mountains are fixed **(d)** that mountains float

8. 'Make the most of a bad situation' best matches Patol Babu's: 1

(a) choice of costume
(b) arrival time
(c) decision to practise the line in many ways
(d) wife's advice

9. The phrase 'greatest prize' is effective because it: 1

(a) names a gold medal
(b) surprises the reader by naming a non-material gain
(c) names a cup
(d) names money

10. Which two images emphasise patience and hope respectively? 1

(a) bone and hill **(b)** tangled string and dark night
(c) hill and pit **(d)** river and coal

11. The poet's view of strength seems to be that: 1

(a) lasting strength lies in patience, not rigidity
(b) strength is noise
(c) weakness always wins
(d) strength is only hardness

12. The writer's attitude to Patol Babu is: 1

(a) indifferent **(b)** bitter
(c) warm and respectful **(d)** mocking

13. Which pair of words best contrasts the story's values? 1

(a) hot : cold **(b)** speed : slowness
(c) rivalry : friendship **(d)** win : eat

14. In 'inky night', the adjective helps by: 1

(a) suggesting deep darkness **(b)** suggesting writing
(c) suggesting day **(d)** suggesting cold

15. Reading 'placed by fate', the Rock's claim could be doubted because: 1

(a) rocks never move **(b)** fate is unknown
(c) seas never reach land **(d)** nothing in nature is permanent

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 5 × 2 = 10

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

16. How does the story challenge the idea of enemies in competition? 2

17. Why is 'willpower' central in the first stanza? 2

18. How does the poem use irony? 2

19. What is the significance of the single word 'Oh'? 2

20. How does the story show the Olympic spirit? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) 5 × 3 = 15

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

21. Discuss whether Long took a risk in helping Owens. 3

22. Why is the swift river image different from the hill image? 3

23. What might the 'Sea' symbolise besides time? 3

24. Compare Patol Babu's theatre days with his film experience. 3

OR

Why is Long's silver medal described as significant? 3

25. Discuss the language of the poem: simple words, strong images. 3

OR

Why might the poet have chosen a rock and sea rather than animals? 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

26. Write a critical appreciation of 'The Rock and the Sea'. 5

OR

Critically appreciate the story 'Patol Babu, Film Star'. 5

27. Critically examine the character of Luz Long and what he represents. 5

OR

'Failure is the first step to success.' Discuss with reference to the poem and your own life. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER **Total: 50 Marks**

MASTERMIND